

CYRIL ZIMA

DIRECTOR / AI FILMMAKER

Los Angeles, CA
cyril.zima@gmail.com

PROFILE: Los Angeles-based Director and Screenwriter working across traditional narrative and character-driven generative filmmaking. Over a decade of directing experience spanning narrative films, commercial production, and digital media, with directed short-form work generating **more than 200 million views online**. Directs both live-action and AI video productions, combining cinematic staging and viral storytelling mechanics with cutting-edge generative AI workflows, character consistency, and digital persona direction.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT FILM DIRECTOR / AI FILMMAKER

Director & Screenwriter • Los Angeles, CA • 2016 – Present

- Direct narrative films, digital shorts, and music videos across live-action and state-of-the-art generative AI production environments.
- Architect end-to-end AI video pipelines: multi-view LoRA prompting, face-locking, and inpainting for strict character consistency across dynamic scene cuts.
- Direct digital personas and virtual companions focusing on emotional performance, facial micro-expressions, lip-sync accuracy, and cinematic camera blocking.
- Apply proven narrative hooks and pacing mechanics to digital video, optimizing audience retention and watch time across online platforms.

COLD NIGHT DREAMS

Film Director • Los Angeles, CA • 2017 – 2020

- Directed and developed narrative and commercial projects from scriptwriting through principal photography, editing, and final post-production.
- Led multidisciplinary crews, talent casting, on-set actor direction, cinematography, and post-production delivery under tight deadlines.

NEFFT STUDIO

Producer / Director / Head of Production • Moscow • 2011 – 2015

- Managed end-to-end commercial studio operations; directed and produced 40+ commercials and 3 television documentary films.
- Oversaw creative treatments, client relationships, budget allocation, and delivery for major advertising and social broadcast campaigns.

TOOLS & SOFTWARE

Generative Video: Veo, Kling, Sora, Seedance, Omni Flash, Higgsfield, Runway Gen-3, Luma

Character & Imagery: Midjourney, Stable Diffusion / ComfyUI, Face-locking/LoRA, Meshy

Lip-Sync & Avatars: HeyGen, LivePortrait, ElevenLabs (Voice/Audio Tuning)

AI Audio & LLMs: Suno, Claude, GPT-4, Gemini, Grok

Post-Production: DaVinci Resolve, Adobe Creative Cloud (Premiere, AE, Photoshop), Final Cut Pro, Final Draft

SELECTED FILMOGRAPHY

AI CHARACTER & MUSIC CONCEPTS (2025–2026)

Director / AI Artist • Generative Shorts & Music Videos
[Proprietary prompt-to-motion pipelines & virtual talent direction](#)

TICKLY TIK (2022)

Director • Horror / Short Film

HOT SET (2017)

Writer / Director • Short Film
[15M views on YouTube](#)

OUTBREAK (2017)

Director / Editor • Drama / Short Film

MOLEHILL (2017)

Director / Editor • Comedy, Drama / Short Film

OCEAN (2016)

Writer / Director • Short Narrative Film
[37M views on YouTube](#) • [149M views for scene trailer](#)

CHARON (2016)

Director / Writer / Editor • Sci-Fi, Thriller / Short Film

SUKA (2014)

Writer / Director • Short Narrative Film
[4M views on YouTube](#) • [50M+ views on Facebook](#)

CORE SKILLS

Directing (Live-Action & AI) • Virtual Personas & Character Consistency • Lip-Sync & Performance Tuning • Generative Video Pipelines • Visual Storytelling • Cinematography & Lighting • Editing & Color Grading • Audience Retention Mechanics

EDUCATION

NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY

MA, Film & Media Production • 2015 – 2016

RUSSIAN ACADEMY OF EDUCATION

MA, Journalism & PR • 2020 – 2022

PEOPLES' FRIENDSHIP UNIVERSITY OF RUSSIA

BA, Journalism • 2000 – 2004